

STAGE THIRTEEN • TEAMWORK & COLLABORATION

FIRSTS

SESSION PLAN

Three sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 30 FIRSTS as a live workshop

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Thirteen • Teamwork & Collaboration

OVERVIEW

Stage Thirteen's thirty FIRSTS split across three sessions, matching the Manual's existing structure: Team Foundations, Working Together in Practice, and Navigating Difficulty & Closing Out. Each session pairs short facilitator framing with individual reflection and, wherever possible, application to a real, current team project.

This stage works best when participants have a genuine team project to apply it to throughout. If your cohort doesn't have one naturally in progress, consider assigning a lightweight shared mini-project at the start of Session 1 purely so Sessions 2 and 3 have something real to reference.

AT A GLANCE

Time	Segment	Format
Session 1	Team Foundations — Q1-Q10	~115 min
Session 2	Working Together in Practice — Q11-Q20	~115 min
Session 3	Navigating Difficulty & Closing Out — Q21-Q30	~115 min

SESSION 1

Team Foundations

Covers FIRSTS Q1-Q10: Team Formation, Team Goal Alignment, Team Roles Defined, Team Working Agreement, Collaborative Planning Session, Collaborative Brainstorming Session, Shared Decision-Making Exercise, Team Task Delegation, Team Accountability System, Team Check-In.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to identify one current or upcoming team project they can reference throughout this entire stage. If none exists, the facilitator should assign a lightweight shared mini-project at the start of this session.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00-0:10	Welcome + framing: teamwork is a learnable practice, distinct from leading a team	Full group
0:10-0:30	FIRST Q1 — Team Formation: confirm genuine alignment	Solo or team, if one exists
0:30-0:45	FIRST Q2 — Team Goal Alignment: confirm shared understanding	Team (or small group simulation)
0:45-1:05	FIRST Q3 — Team Roles Defined: map ownership	Team
1:05-1:10	Short break	—

1:10-1:30	FIRST Q4 — Team Working Agreement: draft norms	Team
1:30-1:55	FIRST Q5 — Collaborative Planning Session: build a plan together	Team
1:55-2:15	FIRSTS Q6-Q7 — Brainstorming + Shared Decision-Making	Team
2:15-2:35	FIRSTS Q8-Q10 — Delegation, Accountability System, Check-In + close	Team, then full-group close

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This session works dramatically better with real teams present rather than solo participants — if your cohort doesn't have natural teams, form temporary groups of 3-4 for the day and treat them as a working team throughout.
- FIRSTS Q6 and Q7 pair naturally; if time is tight, they can run as one continuous block rather than two fully separate segments.
- Close by having each team name their working agreement's single most important norm out loud to the full group — this creates light cross-team accountability.

SESSION 2

Working Together in Practice

Covers FIRSTS Q11–Q20: Collaborative Problem-Solving Exercise, Team Documentation System, Collaborative Digital Workspace, Cross-Functional Team Experience, Multicultural Team Experience, Remote Team Experience, Asynchronous Collaboration Exercise, Team Handoff, Peer Review Within a Team, Team Feedback Session.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring a real, current problem their team is facing, if one exists, for use in FIRST Q11.
- If your cohort includes participants from different functions, cultural backgrounds, or remote locations, note that explicitly — FIRSTS Q14–Q16 benefit directly from that real diversity being present.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + bridge: yesterday was structure, today is how the team actually works together day to day	Full group
0:10–0:30	FIRST Q11 — Collaborative Problem-Solving Exercise	Team
0:30–0:50	FIRSTS Q12–Q13 — Documentation System + Digital Workspace	Team
0:50–1:00	Short break	—
1:00–1:30	FIRSTS Q14–Q16 — Cross-Functional, Multicultural, Remote Team Experience	Solo reflection, then team discussion
1:30–1:45	FIRST Q17 — Asynchronous Collaboration Exercise	Solo
1:45–2:05	FIRST Q18 — Team Handoff: draft a real handoff document	Solo or pairs
2:05–2:25	FIRSTS Q19–Q20 — Peer Review + Team Feedback Session + close	Team, then full-group close

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRSTS Q14–Q16 are reflective rather than purely hands-on; give genuine room for participants without much cross-functional, multicultural, or remote experience yet to reflect honestly on what they'd anticipate rather than forcing a fabricated experience.
- If your cohort is fully in-person and co-located, FIRST Q16 (Remote Team Experience) may need to draw on past experience rather than something happening live — that's fine, note it explicitly rather than skipping the FIRST.
- Peer Review (Q19) works best with real work product to review; if none exists yet, use a draft from Session 1's collaborative plan.

SESSION 3

Navigating Difficulty & Closing Out

Covers FIRSTS Q21–Q30: Team Conflict Resolution, Difficult Teammate Experience, Team Consensus Exercise, Team Compromise, Team Recognition Practice, Team Celebration, Team Retrospective, Team Performance Assessment, Team Lesson-Learned Document, High-Performing Team Experience.

PRE-WORK

- This session covers genuinely harder territory: conflict, difficult teammates, and honest retrospectives. Let participants know upfront that today asks for more honesty than the previous two sessions.
- This is the final session of the stage; it closes with a genuine team retrospective and lesson-learned document, ideally applied to the real project referenced throughout.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today is about navigating real difficulty, not avoiding it	Full group
0:10–0:30	FIRSTS Q21–Q22 — Team Conflict Resolution + Difficult Teammate Experience	Solo reflection, then optional team discussion
0:30–0:50	FIRSTS Q23–Q24 — Team Consensus Exercise + Team Compromise	Team
0:50–1:00	Short break	—
1:00–1:15	FIRSTS Q25–Q26 — Team Recognition Practice + Team Celebration	Team
1:15–1:40	FIRST Q27 — Team Retrospective: full structured session	Team
1:40–2:00	FIRSTS Q28–Q29 — Performance Assessment + Lesson-Learned Document	Team
2:00–2:15	FIRST Q30 — High-Performing Team Experience + full-stage close	Team, then full-group close

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRSTS Q21 and Q22 can surface real, sometimes uncomfortable team dynamics; never require a team to name specifics of an active conflict to the facilitator or full group — private follow-up is always available.
- FIRST Q27 (Retrospective) is the emotional and practical core of this session; give it genuine room rather than rushing it if earlier segments ran long.
- Close the full stage by having each team (or individual) name one specific practice from across all three sessions they're committing to keep using beyond this program — concrete, not aspirational.
- This is a natural moment to preview Stage Fourteen (Project Management), which formalizes much of the structure this stage introduced informally.